

The landscape design is significant as a highly representative example of Victorian estate planning, including the remnant statuary, tree species, fences and gates. The picturesque character of this Victorian landscape is overlaid by 1920s hospital-period landscaping which is of aesthetic and stylistic significance in its own right. The Norfolk Island pines within the lawn are aesthetically significant as landmark trees visible from as far away as Centennial Park. The tower of Edina, visible from the surrounding streets and along the length of Birrell Street, is of similar landmark value.

Some of the 20th century hospital buildings are of aesthetic significance in their own right. The 1935 wing is stylistically rare example of European expressionism, and is sensitive to Edina in its siting and scale. The chapel is a fine and original work of chapel architecture and rare for its time.

Criterion (d): An item has strong or special association with a particular community or cultural group in NSW (or the local area) for social, cultural or spiritual reasons.

The War Memorial Hospital is of some social significance for the high esteem the local community have held for it over the 20th century. People who have had some contact with the hospital, including people who were born there during its time as a maternity hospital, and nurses who trained there, hold it in high regard. There are several expressions of gratitude to the hospital by local community groups located within the hospital, and it continues to be a place of memorial, with buildings, wings and rooms given names in honour of individuals.

Criterion (e): An item has potential to yield information that will contribute to an understanding of NSW's (or the local area's) cultural or natural history.

The site has low archaeological potential; but within the buildings there is some research potential to discover the earlier forms of the Victorian houses.

Criterion (f): An item possesses uncommon, rare or endangered aspects of NSW's (or the local area's) cultural or natural history.

As discussed above, the War Memorial Hospital contains a rare example of European expressionism (1935 main wing) and a 1930s chapel which is rare for its time. As well, the Victorian streetscape of the private street addressed by three Victorian houses built as a set is significant for its rarity. The estate is one of a very small number of Victorian Sydney suburban estates to survive with its spatial order and 19th century planning intact.

Criterion (g): An item is important in demonstrating the principal characteristics of a class of NSW's (or the local area's) cultural or natural places; or cultural or natural environments.

As discussed above, the War Memorial Hospital is an excellent representative example of the philanthropic conversion of a 19th century mansion estate to a community use. The mansion itself is a very good and highly intact example of its type. The establishment of the hospital as a memorial to the First World War is a very good and substantial example of commemorative projects undertaken by private and public organisations in the 1920s.